



Figure 1: The Audacity GUI environment

requirements. The internal microphone (the default recording device of your system) or the external microphone (like your headphones' microphone) is selected when recording your own audio. Stereo Mix should be selected if you want to record the audio from your system (say, from Media Player).

- Recording Channels can either be mono, stereo or as specified by sound device drivers.
 - For a mono recording device (most microphone ports), selecting '2 (Stereo)' in Recording Channels copies the mono source to both channels, producing a dual mono recording.
 - For a stereo device, setting Recording Channels to '2 (Stereo)' ensures that any settings in the system or sound device control panels are stereo.
- In order to select the Playback Device, choose the built-in or attached sound device that you want to use for playback. In Windows, the default Playback Devices are Speakers and Headphones (IDT high definition audio codec), where IDT is the name of the sound card manufacturer.

You will observe two vertical bars to the right, which are meant for resizing the toolbar by clicking and dragging on the bars.

Mixer Toolbar: This has the following features.

Recording volume slider: Sets the recording volume (on the left side)

Playback volume slider: Sets the playback volume (on the right side)

Stereo audio track: Figure 4 shows the separate components of an Audacity stereo track. The signal in the top panel and the vertical scale represent the left channel, while the signal in the bottom panel and the vertical scale represent the right channel.

By clicking on **Mute** in the **Track Control** panel, you can mute the selected track and listen to all other parallel tracks, if any. By clicking on **Solo**, only the selected track is played.

Getting started

Importing and playing existing files: Follow the instructions given below to import and play existing files.

- To load the files into the current project window,



Figure 2: Device Toolbar



Figure 3: Mixer Toolbar



Figure 4: Stereo audio track

choose **File->Import->Audio**.

- Press the **Play** button to start playback.
- Pressing the **Pause** button once will pause playback, and pressing it again will resume the process.
- Press the **Stop** button to stop the playback.

Recording your audio: To record audio, this is what you need to do.

- 1) Set the recording device from the **Device Toolbar**:
 - To record audio (your live audio, any live external musical instrument or both together), select **Internal Mic** (the default recording device of your system) or **External Mic** (to record from your headphones' mic, for instance).
 - To record the system's audio (e.g., a music file from Media Player, or audio from YouTube's live video), select **Stereo Mix** as a Recording Device from the **Device Toolbar**.
- 2) Press the **Record** button to record.
- 3) Stop the recording using the yellow **Stop** button. (You can pause in between by selecting the **Pause** button, and clicking it again to resume.)
- 4) After recording the audio, you can listen to it by clicking the **Play** button.
- 5) To save the audio, choose **File->Export Audio**. Then save it in the desired format from the drop down list. The default extension is the '.wav' format.

Editing the audio: For editing the audio, go to **File->Import->Audio**. If the audio is in the workspace folder of Audacity, then Audacity will offer you the option to open a separate copy of the file for editing, which is recommended.

To select a particular region for editing, click on the track and drag the shaded area with the mouse. If no audio is selected, the entire audio file in the project window is selected, by default.

Figure 5 shows the **Edit Toolbar** in which the **Zoom** buttons are highlighted. The **Q** is the 'Zoom in' tool, and **Q** is the 'Zoom out' tool.

The **Selection Tool** is used to zoom in to get a finer, more in-depth look at the signal. For this, choose the selection tool, then click near the desired location, and click the **Zoom**